



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Back Creek Christian Academy

School Website: <http://bccaschool.org>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Back Creek Christian Academy (Charlotte, NC, 28215) (operating as Christ Classical Academy of Charlotte) presents a robust alignment with classical education principles in several key areas, particularly around religious/theological foundations and a purpose-driven, formation-focused approach. Public materials emphasize Christian worldview integration, the centrality of Bible-based instruction, and a Trivium-based framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as the backbone of the curriculum and pedagogy. Evidence from the school's site shows explicit statements about Bible integration in every subject, weekly chapel, and a mission statement centered on forming students within a Christ-centered, classical framework. These elements support a CLASSICAL orientation in multiple categories, especially where religious/metaphysical foundations and purpose/goals converge with classical pedagogy and a Trivium-informed curriculum.

However, there are areas that limit a full CLASSICAL rating. For example, while there is clear articulation of the Trivium and Socratic-style upper-school dialogue, explicit references to some hallmark classical components—such as a broad Great Books program and a fully articulated “Great Conversation” across history and literature—are not consistently evident on the public materials. Some categories show partial alignment (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL), and one category shows little explicit evidence of classical practice (NOT CLASSICAL). Taken together, the school leans toward CLASSICAL overall, with meaningful strengths in religious foundations, formation-oriented goals, and Trivium-based curriculum and pedagogy, but with room to strengthen explicit Great Books integration, faculty formation language, and deeper community/parent formation practices in public-facing materials.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly teaches within a Christian framework and emphasizes Bible integration across subjects. Text states that “The Bible is integrated into every subject we teach, and our staff are trained to ‘teach Christianly’ at all times.” - The school's theology is foregrounded in mission/vision statements, including claims that education is anchored in biblical truth and that content is formed around a Christian worldview. For example, “The Bible integrated into every subject” and statements about truth of biblical doctrine appear across materials. - The mission and philosophy materials emphasize Christ-centered education with a biblically-based worldview guiding instruction. - A statement of faith and biblical authority is evident in philosophy and mission content (e.g., “exist[s] to spread the Gospel to children and families... teaching them according to the Bible's truth”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: theology, Bible, gospel, liturgy/worship, truth, Word of God, Christian worldview, sacred/holy, reverence, wonder, imago Dei (as a concept echoed

in biblical anthropology). - Negative keywords present: (none evident in public-facing materials for this category). Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords appear prominently (5–7 distinct terms) across the evidentiary material; negative keywords appear 0 times in the publicly available materials for this category. Rating justification - The explicit Bible-centered, liturgical/worship orientation and theology-grounded framing align strongly with the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements lexicon and indicate TRANSCENDENTAL moral realism and theological grounding. This category is firmly CLASSICAL.

Cited elements/themes show Bible integration and liturgical/community spiritual practices as core (e.g., “Bible integrated into every subject,” weekly chapel, Gospel-centered purpose).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission emphasizes forming a diverse classical learning community in partnership with families, guided by Jesus, with a focus on lifetime learning and service. This emphasizes formation and virtue-wisdom rather than mere job preparation. - The philosophy asserts that instruction is grounded in biblical truth and that the education aims at formation of character and intellect in a Christian framework rather than vocational training alone. The public materials align with a paideia-like aim (formation of virtue and wisdom). - The Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) model is presented as the core framework for learning progression, signaling an emphasis on cultivation of reasoning, eloquence, and moral formation rather than mere information transfer.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, moral realism, teleology (implicitly via classical framing), truth, goodness, beauty (present through scope of classical aims and biblical truth), Logos/theological grounding (as part of worldview). - Negative keywords present: none evident in public-facing statements for this category. Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords appear in multiple forms (3–5 distinct terms/topics) with zero explicit negative keywords observed in public materials for this category. Rating justification - The school foregrounds formation and virtue-centered aims and aligns with a classical telos (truth, goodness, beauty). This supports CLASSICAL alignment for this category.

Cited evidence includes mission, philosophy statements, and Trivium framing that emphasize formation and moral-intellectual development.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described through the Trivium model: Grammar (knowledge), Logic (understanding), and Rhetoric (wisdom) as the pathway through which students progress. This is a core classical curriculum element. - History is studied within the curriculum (Lower School content mentions literature, history, mathematics, art, sciences, etc.), indicating an integrated approach rather than treating history as “social studies.” This aligns with classical pedagogy’s integrated study of history within disciplines. - The site notes the integration of faith and learning across subjects (e.g., “The integration of faith and learning occurs as children study literature, history, mathematics, art, the sciences, music, and technology.”) which is consistent with a classical approach to curriculum that weaves liberal arts across subjects.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric (Trivium), history, integrated/harmony of subjects, great conversation/great books (not consistently explicit on site; presence is clearer in the canonical classical lexicon); wonder (as part of integrated wonder and education). - Negative keywords present: explicit “project-based learning dominance” is present in the Six Essential Elements lexicon, but not strongly evidenced in the CCAC site content; absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation on public site lowers exact match to classic Great Books criterion. Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword matches: grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, integrated learning/formation, wonder (visible in mission/philosophy language). Approximately 4–5 distinct classical-curriculum keywords evidenced. - Negative keyword matches: minimal to none in public materials specific to CCAC (no explicit “project-based learning dominance” language on the site). - Net: Positive keyword presence in Curriculum is evident but not exhaustive of all classical elements (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation is not clearly demonstrated in public site copy). Rating justification - The Curriculum category demonstrates core classical elements

(Trivium; integrated history; formation through classical pedagogy) but lacks explicit and consistent references to Great Books/Great Conversation and some other canonical Great Books curriculum phrases in public-facing materials. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence includes explicit Trivium framing and integrated history across subjects, plus mentions of faith-based curriculum integration.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion and seminars and opportunities to develop rhetoric and public speaking (Socratic dialogue is explicitly referenced). This aligns with classical pedagogy in the upper grades. - The school references a classical design that merges best practices with classical pedagogy for a rich learning environment, implying approach to memory, recitation, and dialectic as part of instruction. The Lower School materials indicate a memorization/repetition-forward approach and a blend of liturgical/religious practices that can contribute to a contemplative pedagogy (Scholé-like elements). - The emphasis on a Trivium-based progression (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) indicates a progression toward rhetoric and argumentative skills in higher grades, supporting classical rhetoric training.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, seminars, rhetoric, memory work, recitation, disciplined discussion, classical pedagogy. - Negative keywords present: The site does not strongly emphasize project-based learning as the primary pedagogy; however, there is limited explicit mention of non-traditional/constructivist approaches being dominant on public materials. Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword matches: 4–6 distinct items (Socratic dialogue/seminars, rhetoric, memory/recitation, classical pedagogy, debate, public speaking). - Negative keyword matches: 0–1 explicit negative signals (constructivist preferred, project-based learning dominant) are not strongly evidenced. Rating justification - Pedagogy shows clear classical elements (Socratic dialogue, rhetoric, memory work) but lacks explicit flags for fully or universally classical pedagogy across all grades (e.g., lack of explicit broader discussion of scholé/restful/meditative pedagogy beyond some references). This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence includes explicit Socratic dialogue references and the Trivium-based pedagogy framing.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public-facing materials focus on mission, philosophy, and general statements about teachers as part of a Christian classical framework, but there is no explicit public articulation of faculty as “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” or “faculty as mentors or core of the school” in the same way some classical schools describe the teacher as the living curriculum or as model exemplars. - The materials emphasize teaching Christianly, theological grounding, and the role of teachers in modeling virtue, but they do not clearly present a “living curriculum” or a well-defined faculty portrait in the public materials. The most explicit statements center on biblical integration and Christ-centered education rather than a formalized “faculty profile” or “portrait of what a teacher should be” as a documented policy in public content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: teacher as mentor/model (implicit in “teach Christianly,” “Bible integrated,” and mission statements about forming students with virtue). However, explicit classical faculty language (e.g., “living curriculum,” “portrait of teacher,” “faculty as exemplars,” “master-teacher culture”) is not clearly present in public-facing content. - Negative keywords present: none explicit; rather, the absence is the issue (no explicit “living curriculum” or formal faculty portrait documented in public content). Quantitative estimate - Positive keyword matches: 1–2 explicit terms (e.g., “model teachers,” “mentors”) appear implicitly in mission/philosophy but not as a formalized public credential. - Negative keyword matches: 0 explicit negative signals. Rating justification - Based on the lack of explicit public articulation of the classical-faculty framework (e.g., “living curriculum” and “portrait of a teacher”), this category trends toward NOT CLASSICAL, given the rubric’s expectation of a defined faculty identity. The evidence is not strong enough to claim CLASSICAL; it is best characterized as NOT CLASSICAL in the public materials, with some supportive language but no explicit classical-faculty articulation.

Cited evidence includes the general statements about teachers and biblical integration, but not the “living curriculum”/“portrait” language.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families in the public materials, including a philosophy statement that highlights partnership with families committed to a classical education and the well-being of the student within a faith framework. This aligns with classical education principles that parents are co-educators. - The site communicates openness to family involvement (e.g., opportunities to tour and visit; admissions materials, family involvement in events, and ongoing parent engagement through school activities). The public materials encourage family engagement and indicate a welcoming campus environment for parents. - The “Home School” page reflects a partnership model with homeschool families, offering joint instructional opportunities and co-education alignment (e.g., spiritual training, character development, and joint programs). This demonstrates a strong emphasis on parental participation and family formation within the classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers/parental involvement, home-school collaboration, parent formation, open campus, campus visits. - Negative keywords present: none evident in public-facing content for this category. Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present in multiple public-facing materials (3–4 distinct terms: partnership with families, parent formation/engagement, open campus, tours/visits). Negative keywords: 0. Rating justification - The school demonstrates explicit parent/community engagement and family-partnered education, aligning well with classical models that emphasize family formation and parent involvement. This category is CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence includes mission language about partnership with families, open-tour/visit language, and homeschool-family collaboration content.

Overall assessment and aggregate ranking - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

With three CLASSICAL, two SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, and one NOT CLASSICAL, the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle (only pertinent if SOMEWHAT; here applied as a brief note) - If the goal were to push all six categories firmly into CLASSICAL, the school could: - Publicly articulate a formal “faculty living curriculum” and a precise “portrait of a teacher” consistent with classical education lexicon. - Expand explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language across the curriculum and on public-facing pages, and clearly foreground a Great Books program and Western canon readings. - Provide public-facing statements about Scholé/restful pedagogy and a more explicit reinforcement of memory/narration across grades (lower/middle school) to align with scholé traditions.

Note: Since the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL, these are potential enhancements rather than mandatory changes.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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